

לְלֹמֵד תּוֹרָה עַל מִנַּת לְלֵמֵד, מִסְפִּיקִין בְּיָדוֹ לְלֵמֵד וּלְלֹמֵד. וְהִלּוּמָד. (4:5) we learn a famous rule פרקי אבות. The last מצוה in the תורה is (31:19) לְכַתּוּב לָכֶם אֶת הַשִּׁירָה הַזֹּאת. It's usually translated as "And now, write for yourselves this song." It's specifically referring to האזינו, but we learn the הלכה of writing a ספר תורה, which is called a song to Hashem, from this.

There are two different aspects of this pasuk which have divergent purposes but come to the same conclusion. In פרקי אבות we learn a famous rule (4:5): לְלֹמֵד תּוֹרָה עַל מִנַּת לְלֵמֵד, מִסְפִּיקִין בְּיָדוֹ לְלֵמֵד וּלְלֹמֵד. One of the עיקר purposes of learning and teaching is to accomplish. We can accomplish things in many ways. We can accomplish by doing מצוות, and we can accomplish by sitting and learning. The ר"ש writes in פסקי הרא"ש that in his time there were so many ספרי תורה standing in the ארון קודש that they never got used, and he says a better way to fulfill this מצוה is to write ספרים. As joyous as we are when we have a new תורה, we make a parade and we're so proud and happy to see a ספר תורה joining the ranks of the ספרי תורה, he says that it's an even greater מצוה to write ספרים.

How does the ר"ש know that? Because the pasuk says וְעַתָּה - and now. Why "and now" - only now? He explains that in משה רבינו's time, when there were very few ספרי תורה, each having only one, then כָּתְבוּ meant the מצוה was to write תורה שבכתב. However, in future דורות when there will be many ספרי תורה, it's much better to write חידושי תורה. That is the עיקר of the מצוה - to write דברי תורה. By doing so, a person can fulfill a מצוה דאורייתא according to the ר"ש.

Now, a completely different take on transmitting תורה. This is a fascinating story, the beginning of which you all know and recognize, but most of you have never heard the end. It says in the pasuk (31:28) הִקְהִילוּ אֵלַי אֶת כָּל זִקְנֵי שִׁבְטֵיכֶם וְשִׁטְרֵיכֶם וְאַדְבָּרָה בְּאָזְנֵיהֶם אֶת הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה. You have to write the דברי תורה, but I also have to transmit it orally פה אל פה, from my mouth משה says; וְאַדְבָּרָה בְּאָזְנֵיהֶם - and into their ears; אֶת הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה - all of these things. What are these things? We generally understand it to mean the תורה, that there are many ways of transmitting תורה: writing, speaking, learning, and doing.

We all know the מעשה with תלמי המלך brought down in עמוד א מסכת מגילה דף ט עמוד א, how he gathered 72 זקנים. He wanted to prove or disprove the veracity of תורה. He put them all into separate compartments, went over to each one individually and said, "I want you to translate the תורה of your teacher משה ברוך." הקדוש ברוך put into the heart of each and every one of them the עצה and they all made the same changes so that there shouldn't be any misrepresentation, but they all changed it in exactly the same way, a tremendous נס. (As an aside, we know that when the תורה was translated was a black day in history because it was not meant to be translated.)

The [שלחן ערוך] ש"ך in the ש"ך [which is not the same ש"ך as the ש"ך in the ש"ך] brings the תורה פלאות that which was going to happen to תלמי המלך and the זקנים, that they would have to translate the תורה against their will and would need to make changes so there shouldn't be a לעז, there shouldn't be a rumor חס ושלום about the veracity of the תורה. So משה רבינו gathered together 72 זקנים, and he told them in their ears all of these changes, that these are the changes that would have to be made if the תורה is going to be translated. He instructed them to pass it down in every דור, so that the זקנים would transmit these שינויים to the next generation, until the time of תלמי המלך. That way there could not be any accusation against the תורה.

According to the ש"ך, these 72 זקנים did not make up these changes by themselves. We say הקדוש ברוך הוא put it into their mind, but according to the ש"ך, it was a מסורה from משה רבינו of how to transmit the תורה and how to perpetuate the truth of the תורה by בְּאָזְנֵיהֶם. This goes back to our pasuk of כָּתְבוּ לָכֶם אֶת הַשִּׁירָה הַזֹּאת. We are keeping the תורה eternally that no matter what happens to it, no matter what happens in history, there will not be any לעז against it. They may not agree with us, they may burn the תורה, but no one has ever accused us of falsifying the תורה. That's what this pasuk is saying with בְּאָזְנֵיהֶם, they are not



to change this or to transmit this secret to anyone else but only to the זקנים of each דור so that they would have the genuine changes that משה רבינו instructed them to make.

Bottom line, we all have to do our part to continue transmitting both תורה שבכתב and תורה שבעל פה. No matter what we do, in whatever modality we have, whether it's writing it on white stones or doing it through a podcast, we're being מקיים the מצוה of לימוד התורה. In that זכות, all our children and אייניקלעך will continue that מסורה עד ביאת גואל צדק.



<https://youtu.be/LuwuhzOa7jU>